

THE SEASON, IN FIVE-DAY WEEKS

Keichitsu — 啓蟄

Early March — the *sekk*i when the ground wakes. Its three *kō* read like a held breath let go.

First kō Hibernating insects open their doors. The world below ground decides, before the world above does, that it is time.

Second kō First peach blossoms. The first colour of the year arrives on a bare branch, before a single leaf.

Third kō Caterpillars become butterflies. The proof that the whole long winter was a making, not a stopping.

"Colour comes to the bare branch first. So should it come to the bare room."

